

Lesson 20

Final Practice and Real-World Application



Warm-up

Engage & Exchange: Launchpad - Answer each question sensibly. Use the appropriate key words/phrases from previous lessons.

1. How do you usually start a conversation with someone new at a conference?
2. Can you describe your company's main product or service in one sentence?
3. What is one key strength of your IT department?
4. What's a common IT acronym you use daily, and what does it stand for?
5. How do you explain a technical issue to a non-technical colleague?
6. Can you name one cultural difference to be aware of when working with international IT teams?
7. What phrase do you typically use when suggesting a solution to a problem at work?



Pronunciation Review

Say It Right!

Follow the directions below.

- Work with a partner.
- Each student reads one short passage aloud.
- Your partner listens carefully and writes down any pronunciation mistakes they hear.
- After reading, give friendly feedback to each other.

Passage 1: The Attentive Gaze

A young consultant, eager to impress, began his presentation with unwavering eye contact. His seasoned mentor gently reminded him, **"In some cultures, eye contact is seen as too direct."** The consultant nodded, realizing, **"It's important to be mindful of cultural differences."** During the coffee break, a colleague suggested a different strategy. **"Let's find a culturally appropriate approach,"** she offered, demonstrating how to adapt to different cultures to avoid misinterpretation of even simple **communication styles** and **cultural norms** in **business etiquette**.

Passage 2: Winning the Team Over

The project lead needed to convince the team to adopt a new software. **"Let me explain** why this is beneficial," she started, clearly outlining the advantages. One team member raised a concern. **"I understand your concerns, but..."** the lead responded calmly, ready to handle objections with a strong argument. Her goal was to influence a decision and gain buy-in by highlighting benefits and addressing reservations directly.

Pronunciation Pair Assessment Form

Student A Name: _____

Student B Name: _____

Criteria	Yes	Needs Improvement
Clear pronunciation of individual words		
Correct word stress		
Appropriate sentence stress		
Natural intonation (rise and fall)		
Smooth pace and rhythm		

Comments for your partner (1–2 sentences):



Practice

PART A: DECODE AND CONQUER!

Each category has 3 scrambled words. Unscramble them and guess the correct words.

Category	Scrambled Words
Networking Practice	pportra bestalish mintaina
Organization Basics	partementd erarchihy turstruce
English for IT	oubletrshoot astinfructure ritsecuy
Updating and Delegating Tasks	gdeleate tatsus grproess
Explaining Features and Benefits	tfeaure onstrdemate iqunue

PART B: LANGUAGE IN ACTION

Directions:

- Pair up and receive different role cards: A and B
- Engage in a conversation with your partner based on your task and the scenario's objective.
- Act naturally and work collaboratively towards a realistic outcome.

Persuasive Selling: Closing the Deal

Role Card A:

Role	Lead Sales Representative
Company	Innovatech Solutions
Context	You're meeting a potential client to explain how your product helps teams collaborate better.
Your tasks	- Introduce your software's key business benefits (e.g. time-saving, easy team coordination) - Ask about the client's current system and concerns - Persuade them to schedule a demo or agree to a trial - Use phrases like: I'd recommend... / A possible solution could be..

Role Card B:

Role	Technical Sales Engineer
Company	A logistics firm
Context	You're considering software for your team but have concerns about cost, compatibility, and data security.
Your tasks	- Ask questions about the product's features and limitations - Express concerns (e.g. "We've had issues with complex software before.") - Mention specific technical needs - Use phrases like: The main challenge is... / We need to find a way to resolve this.

Handling Workplace Issues - The Unexpected Feedback

Role Card A:

Role	Team Lead
Company	Synergy Software
Context	You've received negative feedback from your team about unclear project goals.
Your tasks	- Meet with HR to explain the issue - Ask for advice or support on how to improve team communication - Suggest possible actions (training, new tools, weekly check-ins) - Use phrases like: <i>Let's work on a fix together / I'd consider...</i>

Role Card B:

Role	HR Officer
Company	Synergy Software
Context	A team lead approaches you with a workplace concern
Your tasks	- Ask questions to understand the issue fully - Offer support while reminding them of company policy - Propose solutions that align with HR guidelines - Use phrases like: <i>The root cause seems to be... / A possible solution could be...</i>



Production

Language at Work: IT Scenario

Direction: Act out the scenario. Focus on clear communication and applying the target vocabulary and language skills naturally within the given IT context. (3-5 minutes)

1. **Title:** Problems and Solutions: Software Bug Report
2. **Objective:** To practice reporting a technical problem and suggesting a basic solution.
3. **Scenario:** A user reports a minor software bug to an IT support team member.
4. **Roles:**
 - **Team Member 1:** End-User (describing a simple problem)
 - **Team Member 2:** IT Support (acknowledging the problem, asking clarifying questions, suggesting a basic fix)

SUGGESTED FLOW OF CONVERSATION:

1. Reporting the Issue (End-User): Describes the software problem simply
2. Acknowledging and Clarifying (IT Support)
3. Suggesting a Solution (IT Support)
4. Outcome (Both)